

WORKING OUT THE MATH

Gig workers want replacement of the present commission-based model

ON A COMMISSION BASIS (CURRENT MODEL)

243
MILLION

Total
orders in
a quarter

81
MILLION

Average
monthly
orders

₹25

Average payout
per order (com-
mission basis)

► Monthly payout by
the company

₹202 CRORE

ON A FIXED BASIS (WORKERS' DEMAND)

243
MILLION

Total
orders in
a quarter

81
MILLION

Average
monthly
orders

₹40
THOUSAND

Fixed monthly in-
come demand by
q-comm workers

► Monthly payout by
the company

₹1,476 CRORE



NOTE ORDERS AND RIDERS DATA TAKEN FROM ETERNAL'S Q3 RESULTS FOR BLINKIT

PLATFORMS POWERING INDIA'S GIG PLAY

LISTED PLATFORMS	MARKET CAP
► Eternal	\$30 Billion
► Swiggy	\$11 Billion
► Urban Company	\$2 Billion

UNLISTED PLATFORMS	VALUATION
► Flipkart	\$35 Billion
► Zepto	\$7 Billion
► BigBasket	\$3 Billion
► Rapido	\$2.3 Billion
► Ola	\$1.25 Billion
► Snabbitt	\$180 Million

The gig work industry has food delivery and quick commerce platforms like Zomato, Swiggy, among others

WHAT'S POWERING THE GIG BOOM?



900+ MILLION
SMARTPHONE PENETRATION



28 TRILLION
MONTHLY UPI
TRANSACTIONS

SOURCE IAMAI, NPCI

during peak hours, festive seasons or special occasions.

According to Agrawal, the early phase of the system's evolution was about thin order volumes and uncertain consumer demand, making platforms reliant on a hybrid model to attract delivery workers. A small, fixed payout was guaranteed, with the bulk of the earnings linked to performance incentives such as attendance and on-time delivery. As demand scaled and the marketplace reached critical mass, the model

gradually flipped, making a fully variable, per-order structure viable.

"If a delivery worker earns the same for completing 20 orders as he does for 10, the platform economics doesn't work. At its core, this is a free-market system where supply responds to demand. As the ecosystem has matured, the model has shifted from fixed pay to a variable, outcome-linked structure that works at scale," he says.